

Backup and Retention Standard (v2)

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Version 2. Effective date: 1 April 2025. Supersedes: Backup and Retention Standard v1 (February 2023). Approved by: Mei-Ling Tan, Head of IT Security, and Lars Hedegaard, CTO.

Summary of changes from v1

- Daily incremental retention reduced from 35 days to 30 days.
- Weekly full retention increased from 8 weeks to 12 weeks.
- Monthly full retention increased from 12 months to 24 months.
- Offsite replication to the Rotterdam vault changed from weekly to daily.
- New immutable copy tier: all daily backups are written to an object-lock repository and cannot be deleted or altered for 30 days (ransomware protection).
- Restore testing increased from annual to quarterly.
- TesseraCloud retention rules added for the TimescaleDB telemetry store (see ADR-023).

Backup platform

Backups are taken with the Strata Backup platform. Primary repository STRATA-LDS-01 (Leeds data centre); immutable object-lock repository STRATA-LDS-IMM; offsite copy in the Rotterdam vault STRATA-RTM-02.

Backup frequency and retention

Backup type | Frequency | Retention

Daily incremental | Every night, 23:00 local time | 30 days
Immutable daily copy | Every night | 30 days (object lock, cannot be shortened)
Weekly full | Sunday 02:00 | 12 weeks
Monthly full | First Sunday of the month | 24 months
Yearly full (Atlas finance data) | 1 April (start of fiscal year) | 7 years (unchanged)
Atlas month-end pre-close backup (tag MEC-YYYYMM) | BD-3 at 22:00 | 13 months
TesseraCloud TimescaleDB base backup | Daily, 01:00 UTC | 30 days
TesseraCloud WAL archive | Continuous | 7 days

Data retention (TesseraCloud)

Data set | Retention

Raw vibration telemetry (Standard plan) | 400 days (covers the 13-month contractual commitment)
Raw vibration telemetry (Enterprise plan) | 36 months, older chunks held in compressed archive tier
1-minute aggregates | 5 years
Hourly aggregates | Life of customer contract plus 1 year
Audit log (tc-api) | 2 years

Offsite copies

Every daily backup is replicated to STRATA-RTM-02 in Rotterdam by 06:00 UK time. Replication failures raise a Beacon ticket in category SEC-BACKUP automatically and must be resolved within one business day.

Restore testing

Restore tests are performed quarterly (in the first month of each fiscal quarter: April, July, October, January). Each test restores Atlas to an isolated host, one file share and one TesseraCloud tenant. Results are recorded in Beacon category SEC-BACKUP-TEST. A failed restore test is treated as a SEV2 incident (previously SEV3).

Encryption and access

All backups are encrypted at rest with AES-256. Deletion of backup sets before expiry requires two approvers from IT Infrastructure and IT Security. Backup administrator accounts must use FIDO2 MFA per the Password and MFA Standard v2.

Review

This standard is reviewed annually.